HPE INTERVIEW PREP

POSITIONING HPE OBSERVABILITY AT COMCAST

Company context · Recent news · Portfolio · Comcast account strategy · Interview Q&A

Prepared October 2026 · Use the right arrow to begin

HPE AT A GLANCE

- **Strategy:** hybrid cloud, AI, and networking, delivered as-a-service through **HPE GreenLake**
- **Juniper Networks acquisition closed July 2025**, so networking is now central to the story (HPE Aruba Networking + HPE Juniper Networking)
- **Fiscal Q3 revenue: $12.21B**, up 33.7% year over year
- **Growth drivers:** AI servers, networking, and the GreenLake cloud platform
- **Stock:** up ~152% over the past year; closed at $55.87 on Oct 19, 2026

RECENT NEWS (OCTOBER 2026)

- **Oct 21:** Partnership with **NVIDIA** on secure agentic AI
- **Oct 20:** Spaceborne Computer work aimed at missions to the Moon
- **Oct 19:** Connectivity deal with the **Miami HEAT**
- **Oct 7:** New AMD-powered servers and the **ProLiant Gen13** line
- **Mid-Oct:** Barclays (to Equal Weight, $77 target) and Evercore ISI (to In-Line) downgraded the stock on **valuation**, not business fundamentals

Check the HPE Newsroom the morning of the interview for anything newer.

HPE OBSERVABILITY PORTFOLIO

Offering	What it does
OpsRamp	Multi-vendor observability and AIOps across servers, VMs, Kubernetes, public cloud, and networks
GreenLake Intelligence	Agentic AI framework for IT operations; includes the **OpsRamp Operations Copilot** (monitors AI agents and token usage)
Juniper Mist / Marvis + **Aruba Central**	Self-driving wireless, wired, and SD-WAN networks
Apstra + Data Center Assurance	Data center network assurance, linked to OpsRamp and Compute Ops Management
Morpheus + Zerto	Hybrid cloud management and resilience, unified with OpsRamp

Announced at HPE Discover Barcelona 2025 and Discover 2026 (June).

COMCAST: ACCOUNT CONTEXT

- **Connectivity & Platforms:** Xfinity residential and **Comcast Business**
- **Content & Experiences:** NBCUniversal, **Peacock**, Sky
- **Strong in-house engineering culture**: builds much of its own tooling
- **Software-defined network push:** chose **DriveNets** Network Cloud (2025) and is targeting AI-driven self-healing
- **Unknown, so ask in discovery:** current observability stack, Juniper/Aruba installed base, and who owns the decision

POSITIONING THESIS

*An **AI-driven operations layer that works across vendors** and sits on top of what Comcast already runs.*

- **Not** a replacement for Comcast's carrier network monitoring
- **Win with:** fewer tools, faster fixes (lower MTTR), and AI agents that take on trouble tickets
- **Start where HPE has a clear advantage**, then expand

WHERE TO LAND (IN ORDER)

1. **Internal IT & hybrid cloud:** OpsRamp to consolidate tools; GreenLake pay-as-you-go pricing
2. **NBCU / Peacock streaming:** visibility from network to application at peak load (live sports, Olympics)
3. **Comcast Business managed services:** Mist/Marvis + multi-tenant OpsRamp powering managed Wi-Fi and SD-WAN, which **makes HPE a revenue partner**
4. **AI infrastructure:** Apstra + Compute Ops Management + OpsRamp for GPU clusters; agent and token monitoring
5. **Carrier core (hardest):** correlate across DriveNets, Cisco, and Juniper without replacing anything

KEY MESSAGES

- **“Bring your tools”:** OpsRamp works with existing monitoring, ticketing, and in-house tools. No lock-in.
- **Agentic operations with controls:** a phased path to AI agents closing tickets, with the governance and audit trail of GreenLake Intelligence
- **Network + compute + operations from one vendor:** with Juniper, HPE links network health to server and application health
- **Business outcomes:** fewer alerts, lower MTTR, fewer truck rolls, lower tooling cost

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Competitor	HPE counter
Cisco (Splunk, ThousandEyes)	Hardware-neutral OpsRamp; simpler network + compute story
Datadog / Dynatrace / New Relic	Hybrid infrastructure and network depth; agentic remediation
ServiceNow	Partner, not rival: send OpsRamp incidents into ServiceNow
Kentik	Existing Juniper partner, so treat as an ally

HPE VS. DELL FOR VMWARE MIGRATION

	HPE	Dell
Hypervisor	Its own: **VM Essentials**, licensed per socket	Third-party (VMware, Nutanix, Red Hat, Microsoft)
Management	**Morpheus** runs VMware and HPE side by side	Mostly partner tools
Migration & recovery	Morpheus migration tools + **Zerto**	Mostly partner tools
Observability	**OpsRamp** before, during, and after the move	Mostly partner tools
Compute	**Gen13** 6th Gen AMD EPYC, iLO 8 security	PowerEdge (incl. 1P R6715/R7715)
Support & buying	One vendor; GreenLake or purchase	Several vendors; APEX or purchase

Per-socket licensing + high-core servers = fewer licenses, less power. Broadcom licenses per core, so denser servers raise the VMware bill.

ANSWERING DELL'S OBJECTIONS

- **“Choice of hypervisors, no lock-in.”** Morpheus also manages other vendors’ platforms, and HPE adds its own lower-cost hypervisor
- **“VM Essentials is less mature.”** Agree; propose a phased pilot on ordinary workloads, keep VMware where needed, prove it with OpsRamp data
- **“We’re the incumbent at the edge, cheaper at scale.”** Compete on total cost: servers + licensing + power + operations
- **“Nutanix is proven.”** It’s another software vendor with its own pricing; HPE’s per-socket model coexists with VMware

> *“HPE delivers the whole path off VMware, under one contract, with one partner accountable for the result.”*

VMWARE TO VM ESSENTIALS: WHAT CHANGES

VMware feature	Under VM Essentials	Status
vMotion / HA	Live migration and clustering-based HA	✅ Covered
DRS (workload balancing)	Listed by HPE; maturity unclear	⚠️ Confirm
Fault Tolerance	No confirmed equivalent	❌ Likely gap
NSX (microsegmentation, distributed firewall)	Open vSwitch basic switching	❌ Gap
vSAN	External shared storage (e.g., HPE Alletra)	❌ Gap
Aria (ops, automation)	Morpheus Enterprise + OpsRamp	🔄 Replaced
Site Recovery Manager	Zerto	🔄 Replaced
Tanzu (Kubernetes)	Morpheus orchestrates standard Kubernetes	🔄 Different
vGPU, scale limits, Horizon VDI	Confirm support; VDI is separate	⚠️ Confirm

Few current public comparisons exist; treat as a checklist to confirm with HPE.

ECOSYSTEM GAPS & POSITIONING

Often bigger than the feature gaps:

- **Vendor certification:** many VNFs and appliances are certified only on ESXi, a likely Comcast blocker
- **Tooling:** confirm backup (Cohesity, Rubrik, Veeam), security, and monitoring support for KVM
- **Scripts & integrations:** PowerCLI, vCenter plugins, ServiceNow/CMDB need rework
- **Skills:** train operations staff on KVM and Morpheus

Positioning: move simple VMs first; keep NSX, vSAN, FT, and ESXi-certified workloads on VMware, managed side by side in Morpheus; fill gaps with Alletra, Zerto, OpsRamp, and Juniper; price replacements into the TCO.

PROLIANT: THE PLATFORM FOR CEPH

"Ceph is free; running it isn't. HPE makes Ceph cheaper and safer to operate at scale."

Pillar	HPE offering
Servers tuned per Ceph role	Dense 1P NVMe ProLiant (DL325/DL345 class); DL380/DL385 for capacity
Fleet lifecycle	Compute Ops Management firmware baselines; iLO remote management and security
Network for rebuild traffic	Juniper/Aruba 25/100/400GbE + Apstra
Observability	OpsRamp ingests Ceph's Prometheus metrics, ties issues to root cause
Support & buying	One vendor for server to switch; GreenLake capacity on demand

Don't replace Comcast's Ceph; be the best place to run it. Offer the X10K where turnkey fits (AI, backup, media). Pilot: measure rebuild time, latency, operator hours per PB.

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS FOR COMCAST

- What observability and AIOps tools do you run today? How many, and at what cost?
- Where is Juniper, Aruba, or HPE equipment already installed?
- What are your MTTR and ticket-volume targets? How far along is automation?
- Who owns the decision: corporate IT, Technology & Product, Comcast Business, or NBCU?
- How do you weigh building tools in-house versus buying them?

PROOF: 30–60 DAY PILOT

- **Scope:** one area, e.g. Peacock live-event infrastructure **or** one Comcast Business managed service
- **Targets agreed up front:**
  - Fewer alerts (noise reduction)
  - Lower MTTR
  - More tickets closed automatically
- **Bring references:** telecom and media customers using OpsRamp and Mist
- **Expansion path:** success in one area leads to the next entry point

LIKELY INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

- **Why HPE, and why now?** Juniper + GreenLake + agentic AI make a full-stack story
- **How would you position OpsRamp against Splunk or Datadog?** Multi-vendor, hybrid, network-aware, agentic
- **Walk us through a complex, multi-stakeholder deal.** Use STAR: Situation, Task, Action, Result
- **How would you open a large, engineering-led account like Comcast?** Discovery first, small pilot, measurable outcomes
- **What do the recent analyst downgrades mean?** Valuation concerns, not business fundamentals

QUESTIONS TO ASK YOUR INTERVIEWERS

- How is the Juniper integration changing how the team sells observability?
- Which accounts or segments are top priority for OpsRamp and GreenLake Intelligence this year?
- How does this role work with partners such as NVIDIA and ServiceNow?
- What does success look like in the first 90 days?

SOURCES

- HPE Newsroom
- HPE: Unified agentic IT operations (June 2026)
- HPE: Self-driving networks (June 2026)
- Futurum: HPE Discover 2026
- NAND Research: HPE Discover 2026 recap
- The Register: HPE networking chief on AI tickets (Oct 2026)
- Yahoo Finance: Evercore downgrade
- HPE: Introducing ProLiant Gen13 (Oct 2026)
- HPE: Morpheus VM Essentials, a VMware alternative
- Dell: Latest PowerEdge servers
- BusinessWire: Comcast and DriveNets (2025)